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THE UNEQUAL ALGORITHM
-A DATA STORY

How AI is reshaping affordability for students, workers, and professionals in Oshawa?

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https://thepriceofopportunity.my.canva.site/the-unequal-algorithm

TOPIC DEVELOPMENT

Initial idea:

Is AI affecting student life in the GTA for better or worse?

Conducted research on:

Tuition costs Student expenses (Ontario Tech & Durham College)

Problem identified:

Topic too broad and hard to measure “Better or worse” is subjective.
Unclear focus (which students/programs?)

Final research question:

How is AI reshaping affordability for students, workers, and professionals in Oshawa?

METHOD AND DATA

Key factors analyzed:

Income Expenses Cost of AI tools

Core concept:

AI cost as % of disposable income

Data collected:

Prices of AI tools

Average income for 3 personas: Student Worker Professional

Visualization:

Compared time saved vs money spent/saved

Tools used:

Python (initial graphs), Canva (interactive storytelling version)

SOURCES

1. Statistics Canada – 2021 Census Income Data (Neighborhood Profile)
https://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2021/as-sa/fogs-spg/alternative.cfm?dguid=2021A00053518013&lang=e&objectId=5_3&topic=7&utm_

2. Spergel – The Cost of Living in Ontario
https://www.spergel.ca/learning-centre/the-cost-of-living-in-ontario/

3. Statistics Canada – Household Income (Quality of Life / Prosperity)
https://www.statcan.gc.ca/hub-carrefour/quality-life-qualite-vie/prosperity-prosperite/household-income-revenu-menage-eng.htm

4. WealthNorth – Average Household Income in Canada / Ontario
https://wealthnorth.ca/income/average-household-income/

5. Coda One – AI Tools Pricing Report 2026
https://www.codaone.ai/blog/ai-tools-pricing-report-2026/

6. Hashmeta – Generative AI Pricing Guide
https://www.hashmeta.ai/en/generative-ai/generative-ai-pricing

THANK YOU.